
NET : NEUROENDOCRINE TUMOURS

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NET Patient Foundation

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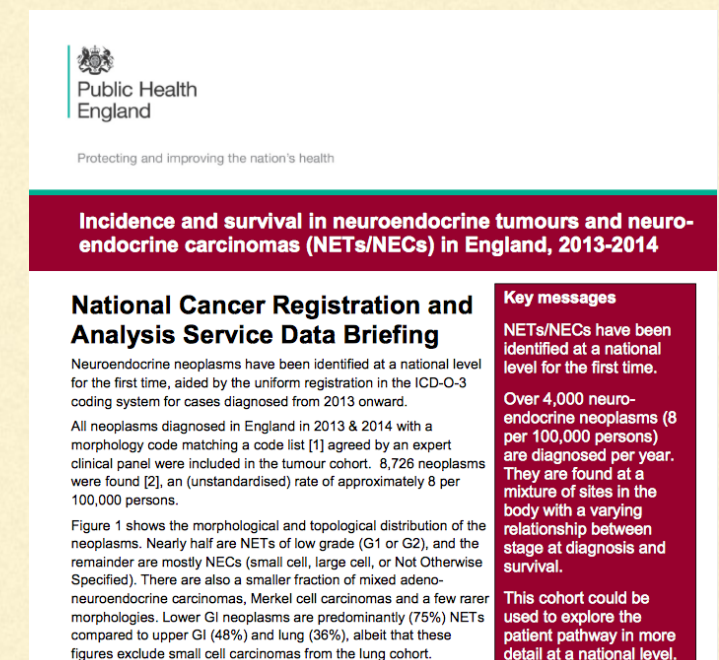
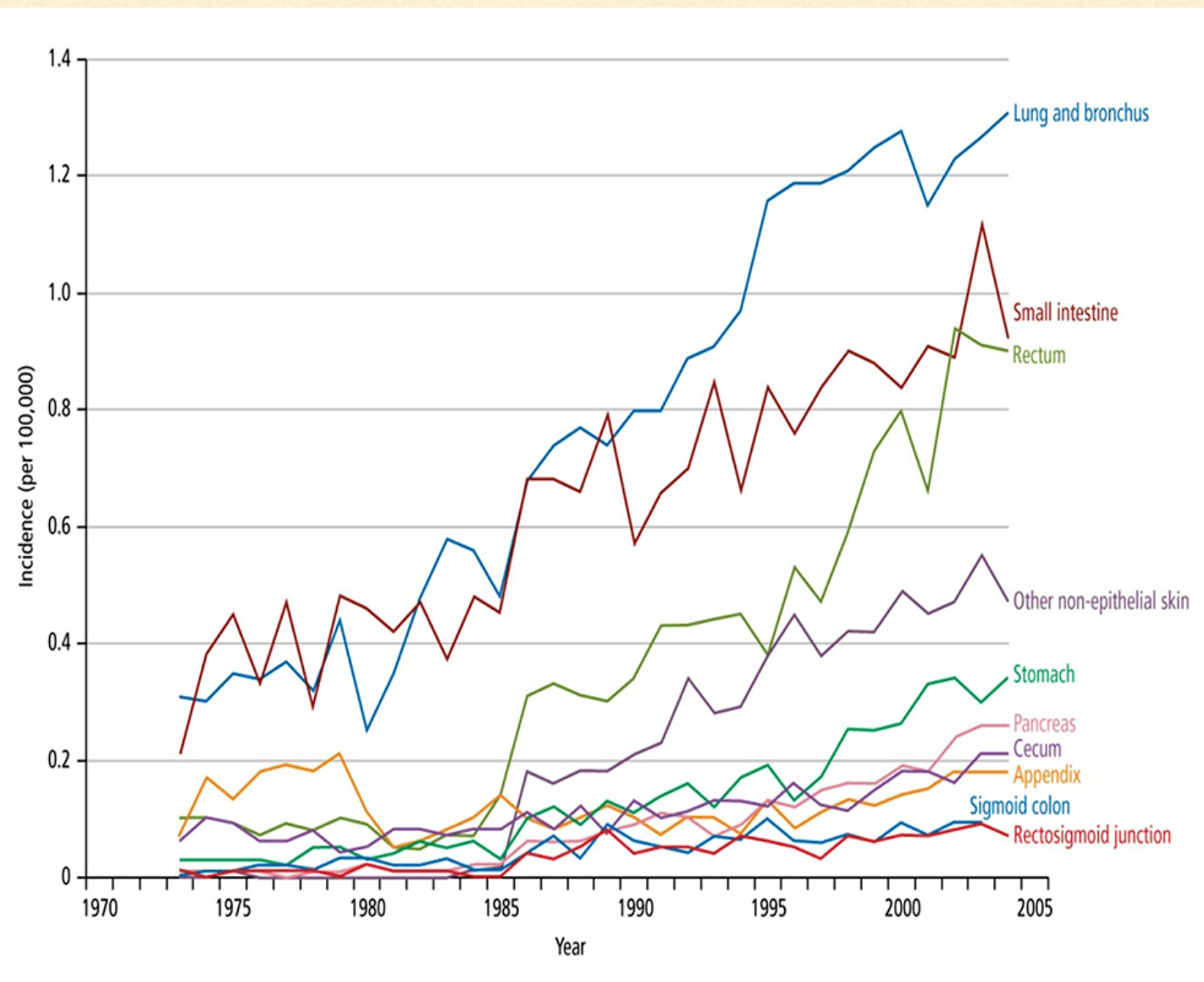
- Why look at NETs ?
 - What is cancer - are NETs cancer ?
 - What are NETs - where do they occur ?
 - How are they classified ?
 - Implications for prognosis
 - Real life application
 - Sources for further information
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NET : NEUROENDOCRINE TUMOURS

Global increase in incidence

nb high prevalence

In UK - PHE data

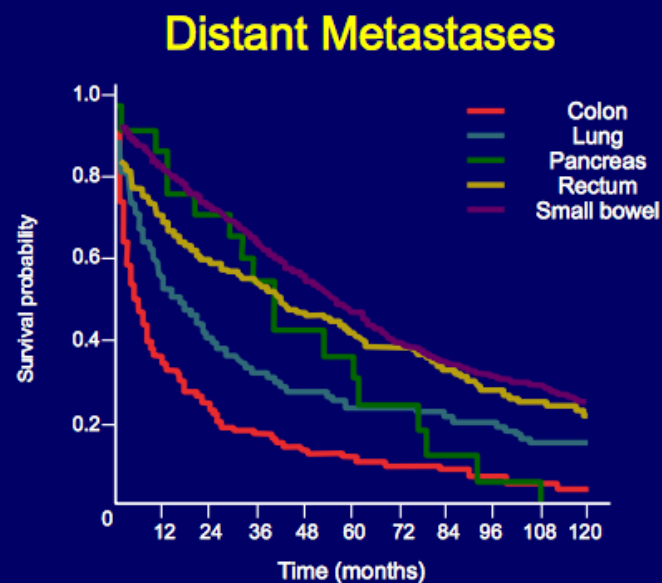


NET : NEUROENDOCRINE TUMOURS

Correlation of Primary Tumour Site with Survival

Known prognostic factors include:

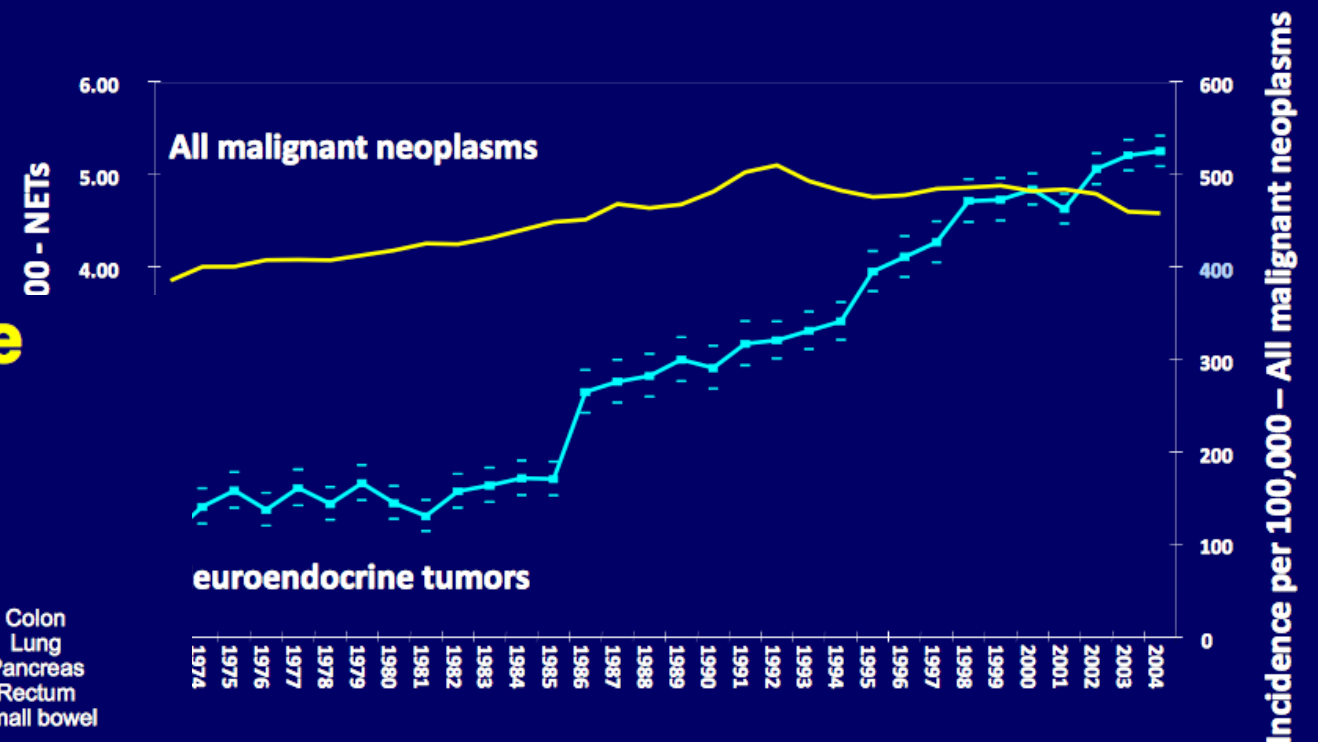
- Location of primary tumour
- Extent of disease
- Tumour stage
- Degree of differentiation/proliferative index (PI)
- Tumour grade
- Patient age
- Performance status



65% of patients with advanced NET will not be alive in 5 years

Yao JC, et al. *J Clin Oncol.* 2008;26:3063-3072.

Incidence of NETs Increasing



Yao JC et al. *J Clin Oncol.* 2008;26:3063-3072.

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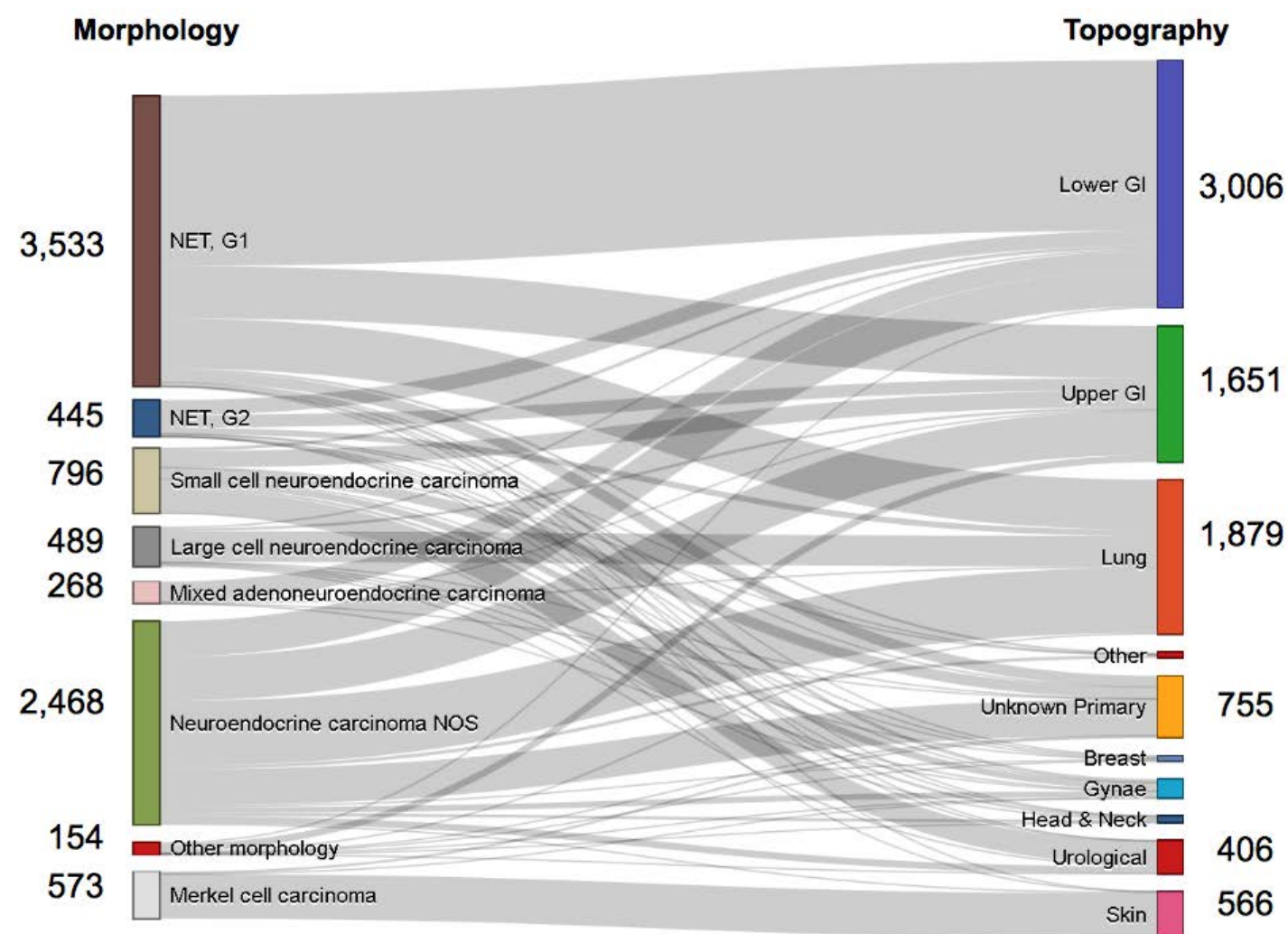


Figure 1: morphological and topological distribution of 8,726 neuroendocrine neoplasms diagnosed in England, 2013 and 2014

4,000 = 8 : 100,000 (England)

High % G1 NETs = Lower GI

High % G3 = Lung

G1 = <3% NET

G2 = 3-20% NET

G3 = >20% well / poorly

NET or NEC

nb > or <55%

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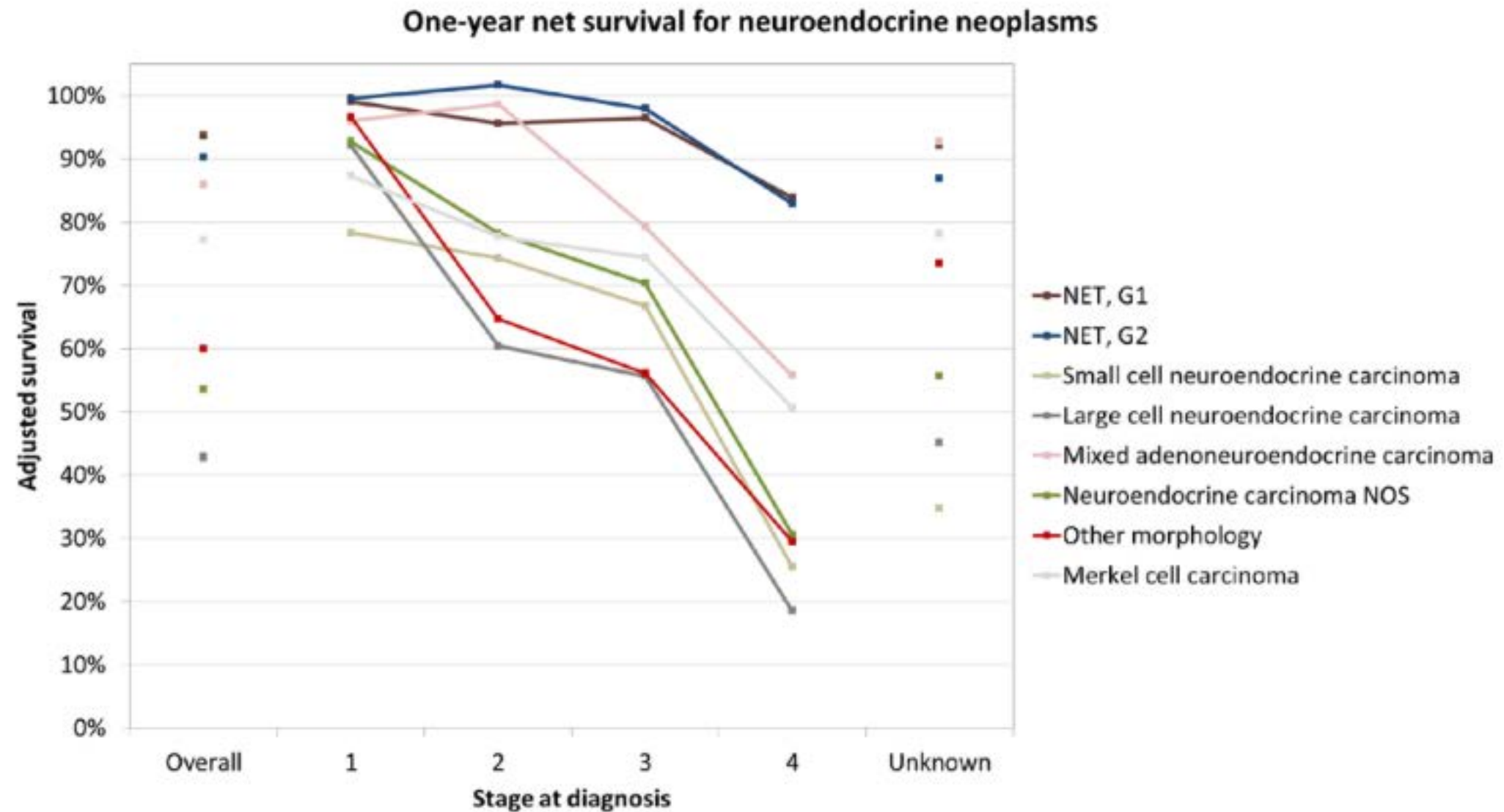


Figure 2: one year net survival for neuroendocrine neoplasms diagnosed in England, 2013-2014.

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Cancer – **excluding "less advanced" cancers**

Any malignant tumour positively diagnosed with histological confirmation and characterised by the uncontrolled

All cancers which are histologically classified as any of the following :

pre-malignant

non-invasive

cancer-in-situ

having either **borderline malignancy** or

having **low malignant potential**

Malignant :
characterized by uncontrolled growth;
cancerous, invasive, or metastatic.
Immortal, invasive and itinerant !

All tumours of the prostate unless histologically classified as having a Gleason score of 7 or above or having p

Any skin cancer (including cutaneous lymphoma) other than malignant melanoma that has been histologically

<http://www.aviva.co.uk/adviser/product-literature/files/da/da09003c.pdf> : accessed February 2017

NET : NEUROENDOCRINE TUMOURS

"Borderline malignancy" : potentially malignant cells that form in the tissue covering the

"Low malignant potential" : potentially malignant cells that form in the tissue covering

nb ENETs and AJCC : T1 $\leq$ 1 cm; invasion of muscularis propria

**The new WHO and TNM classifications of GEP-NENs
determine prognosis - metastatic potential of the tumors
based on**
-histologic differentiation- well or poor
-proliferative activity-G1,G2,G3
-tumor extension – size
-angio invasion

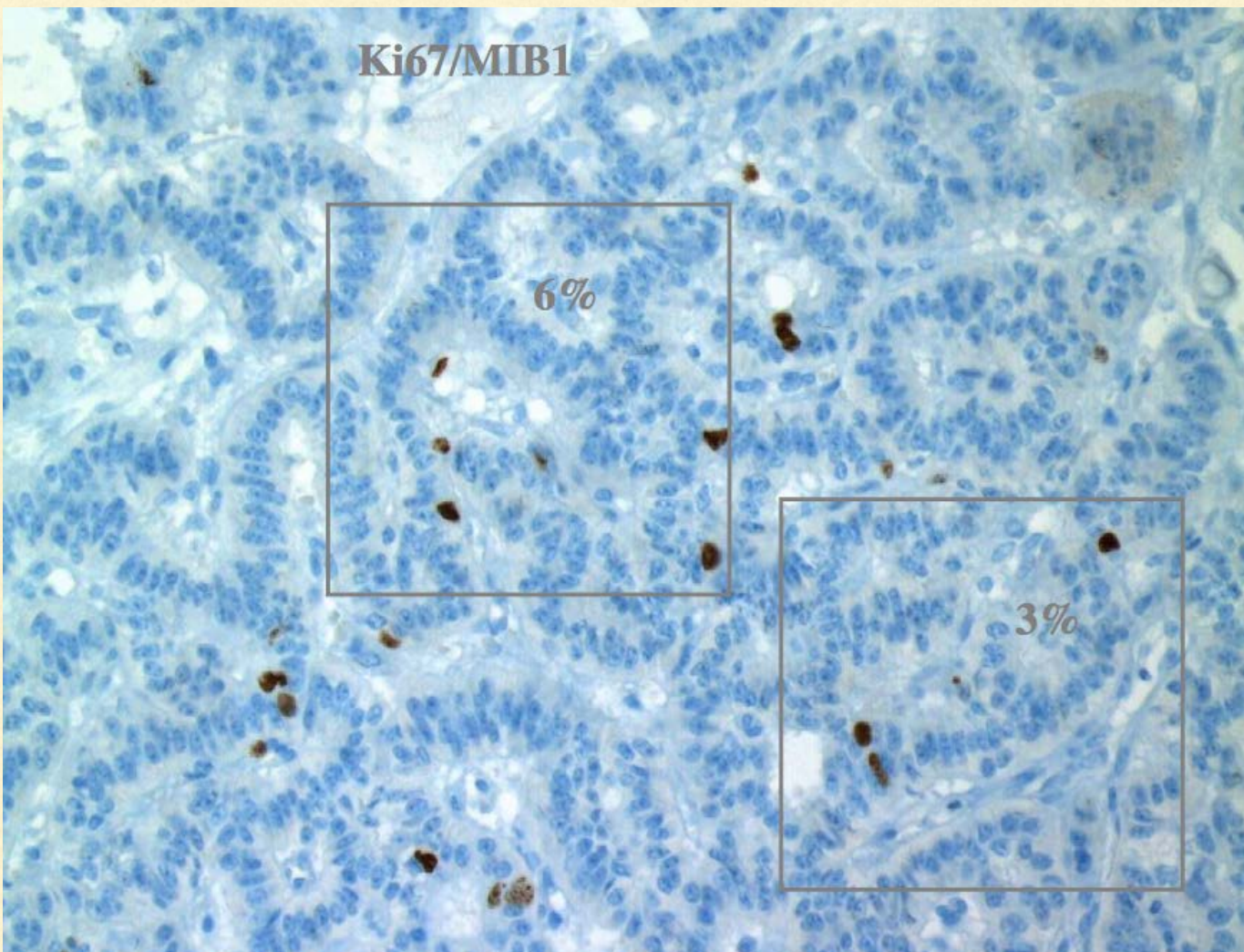


All NETs have malignant potential

"Terminal" : incurable, with a life expectancy / prognosis < 12 months.

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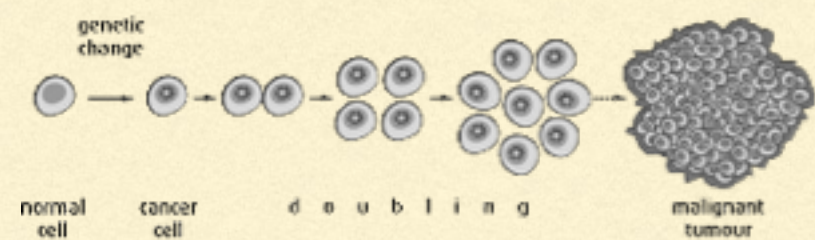
- Uniform, organised, nucleus to cell size ratio, communicate, react, specialise (mature), stick together, look alike, repair and/or self destruct (apoptosis) and die.
- Heterogenous, disorganised, large nucleus, ignore / interrupt cell signalling - don't communicate, no specialisation (immature), do not stick together, look different, faulty repair mechanism, over-ride self-destruct signals, immortal.
- NETs have the latter characteristics
- NETs can exhibit different behaviour between sites
- NETs can exhibit different behaviour within the same tumour

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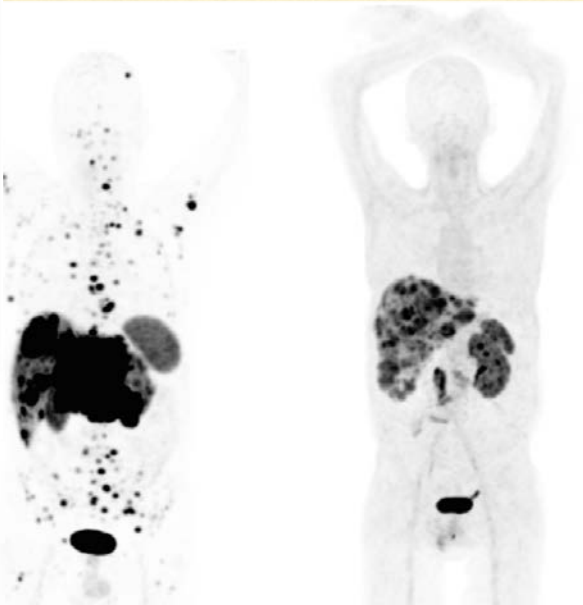
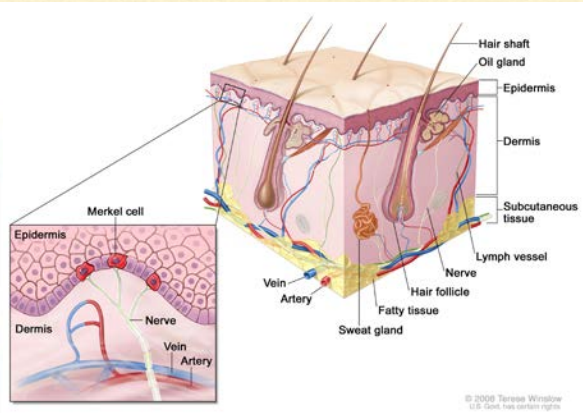
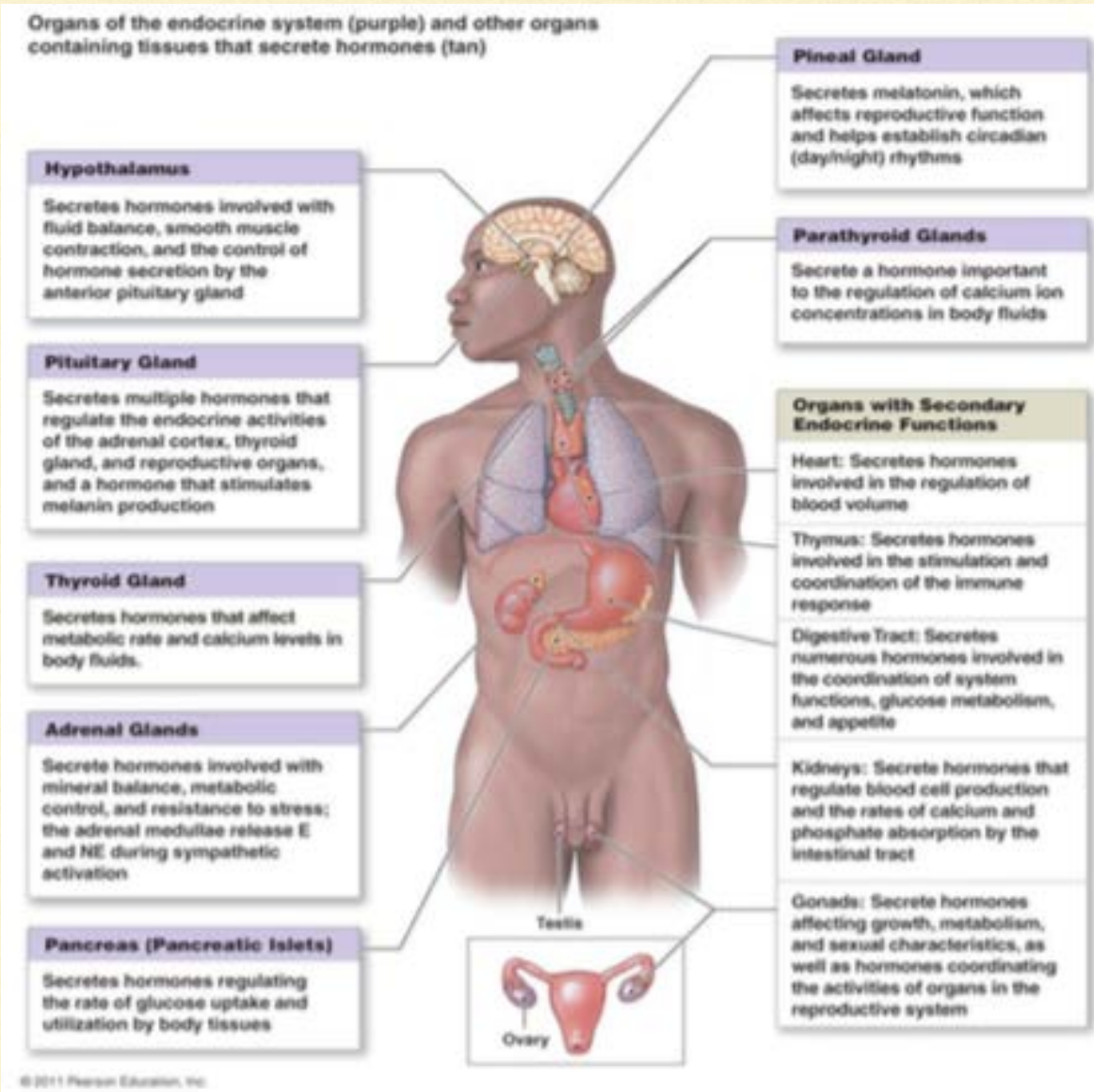
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Cancer Development



NET is umbrella term

Normal	Cancer	
		Large, variably shaped nuclei
		Many dividing cells; Disorganized arrangement
		Variation in size and shape
		Loss of normal features

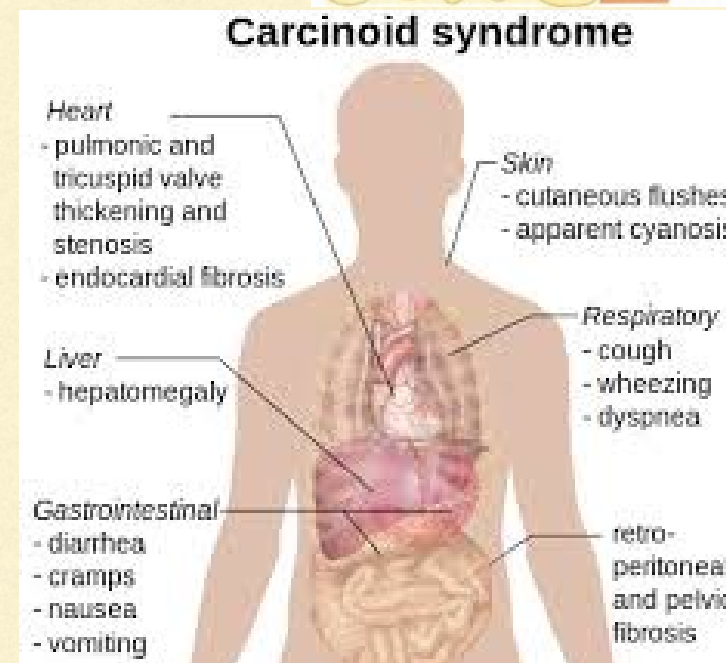
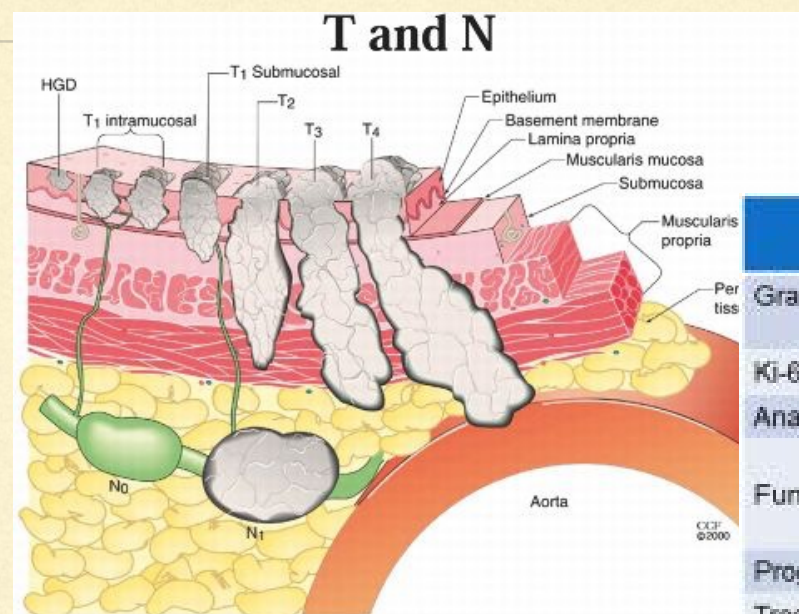


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- Site
- Size
- TNM Staging
- Grading
- Function



	Well-differentiated		Poorly differentiated
Grade (ENETS)	Low (G1)	Intermediate (G2)	High (G3)
Ki-67 index (%)	≤2	3-20	>20
Anatomic imaging	more rapid growth on serial imaging		
Functional imaging	Octreoscan SPECT or SSTR PET +ve FDG PET +ve		
Prognosis	Indolent (slowly growing)		Aggressive
Treatment options	Surgery for localised +/- resectable metastatic disease Observation Somatostatin analogues Radionuclide therapy Everolimus, sunitinib, α-interferon Liver metastases: radiofrequency ablation, hepatic embolisation, TACE, SIR-Spheres		

Differential Diagnosis (3)

Clinically PB can be distinguished from the following neuroendocrine tumors due to their different spectrum of symptoms:

Disease	Features
Insulinoma	Hypoglycemia, behavior changes, weight gain and/ or morning seizures
Gastrinoma	Severe gastrointestinal ulceration and diarrhea
VIPoma	Watery diarrhea, hyperkalemic and achlorhydria
Glucagonomas	Migratory necrolytic dermatitis, weight loss, stomatitis, anemia and hyperglycemia
Somatostatinomas	Diarrhea and may develop diabetes mellitus

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Carcinoid Heart Disease

- In patients with carcinoid tumors,
- Cardiac involvement, principally of the endocardium and valves of the right heart.
- **The Carcinoid syndrome**
 - distinctive episodic flushing of the skin and cramps,
 - nausea, vomiting, and diarrhea
 - bronchoconstrictive episodes resembling asthma.
 - **cardiac lesions** in about one-half (tricuspid and pulmonic valves may malfunction, with tricuspid regurgitation).

Clinical Manifestations

- Carcinoid syndrome consists of a triad: flushing, diarrhoea and bronchospasm.
- Between 20-50% of all patients with carcinoid syndrome will develop carcinoid heart disease.
- Vasoactive substances such as 5-hydroxytryptamine produced by neoplastic cells are able to travel to the right heart via the hepatic vein/IVC and are thought to be responsible for deposition of endocardial plaques of fibrous tissue.
- Classically patients develop signs and symptoms of right heart failure: fatigue, oedema and ascites.

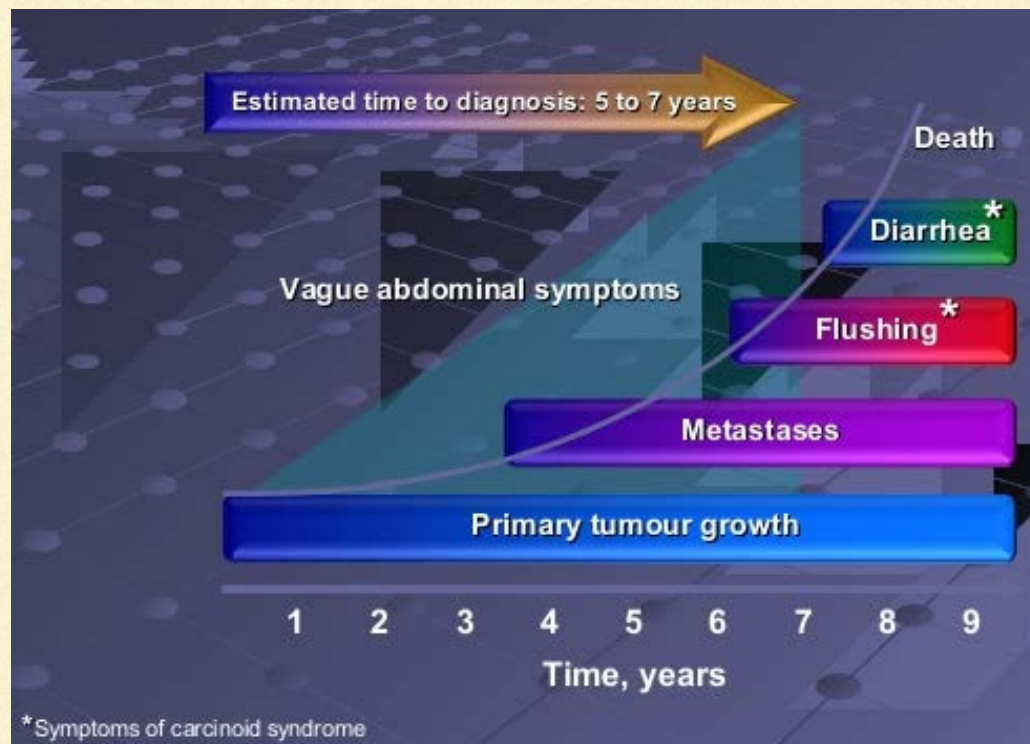
Carcinoid syndrome



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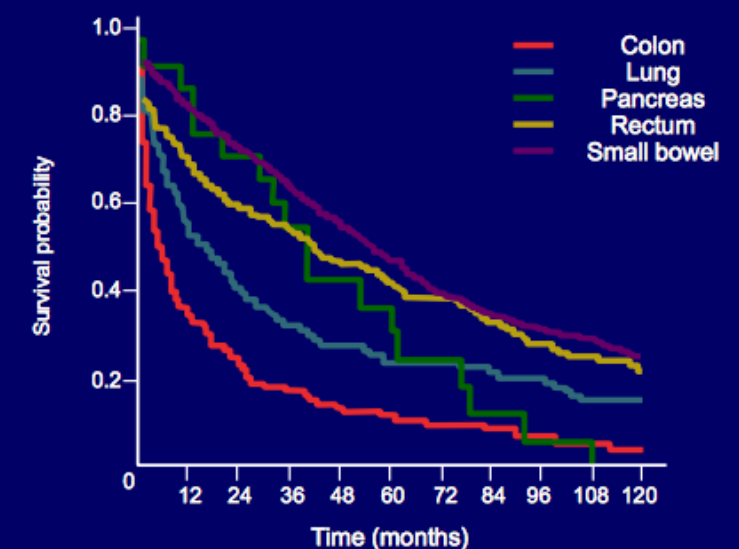
Disease
Treatment
Other Factors

Correlation of Primary Tumour Site with Survival

Known prognostic factors include:

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Distant Metastases



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- www.netpatientfoundation.org
- www.ukinets.org/
- www.enets.org/